

CAROLINE MIEHE

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NOVAFRICA, Rua da Holanda 1, 2775 – 405 Carcavelos, Portugal • born on Sep 29, 1993, in Berlin, Germany

Mission statement Through randomized field experiments and primary data collection, I study how economic principles – such as decision-making under risk and asymmetric information – can inform strategies to strengthen the resilience of communities confronting poverty and climate change in sub-Saharan Africa.



Education **KU Leuven, Belgium**
Doctor of Economics, 2019 – 2023
Ph.D. supervisor: Johan Swinnen

Master of Business Administration, 2017 – 2018
graduated with 87,75% (greatest distinction)

University of Potsdam, Germany
Bachelor of Business Administration, 2012 – 2016
graduated with 82% (great distinction)

Relevant working experience	2024 – now	Postdoctoral researcher	NOVAFRICA, Nova University Lisbon, Portugal
	2019 – 2023	Ph.D. candidate & teaching assistant	LICOS, KU Leuven, Belgium
	2022 – 2022	Research employee	DEC, Wageningen University, Netherlands
	2013 – 2015	Teaching assistant	University of Potsdam, Germany

Publications	Journal articles	Miehe, C., Nabwire, L., Sparrow, R., Spielman, D. J., & Van Campenhout, B. (2025). Miracle seeds: Biased expectations, complementary input use, and the dynamics of smallholder technology adoption. <i>Economic Development and Cultural Change</i> , 74(1), 305–334. De, A., Miehe, C., & Van Campenhout, B. (2024). Gender bias in customer perceptions: The case of agro-input dealers in Uganda. <i>Agricultural Systems</i> , 217, 103954. Mogues, T., Van Campenhout, B., Miehe, C., & Kabunga, N. (2023). The impact of community-based monitoring on public service delivery: A randomized control trial in Uganda. <i>World Development</i> , 172, 106374.
	Peer-reviewed report	Van Campenhout, B., Kabunga, N., Mogues, T., & Miehe, C. (2021). Community advocacy forums and public service delivery in Uganda. <i>3ie Impact Evaluation Report 136</i> .
	Book chapter	Swinnen, J., Miehe, C., & Emmers, D. (2021). COVID-19 en voedselzekerheid. In B. Pattyn, & P. d’Hoine (Eds.), <i>Lessen voor de 21ste eeuw: Weten wat telt in tijden van crisis</i> (pp. 69–84). Leuven Univ. Press.

Media

- Caetano, P., Leeffer, S., Macdonald, J., Vicente, P. C., Miehe, C., & Calaim, N. (2025, October 22). Community action against floods: Climate adaptation in coastal Mozambique. *International Growth Centre Blog*.
- Miehe, C., Nabwire, L., Sparrow, R., Spielman, D. J., & Van Campenhout, B. (2025, May 21). How misinformation and mismatched expectations reduce adoption of improved seeds. *VoxDev Article*.
- Miehe, C., Nabwire, L., Sparrow, R., Spielman, D. J., & Van Campenhout, B. (2023, June 22). “Miracle seeds,” informational curses? The risk of high expectations for new agricultural technologies. *IFPRI Blog: Research Post*.
- De, A., Miehe, C., & Van Campenhout, B. (2023, March 17). This is a man’s world: Gendered perceptions of Ugandan agro-input dealers. *IFPRI Blog: Research Post*.
- Van Campenhout, B., Miehe, C., Spielman, D. J., & Sparrow, R. (2022, April 4). What changed when Ugandan farmers rated input quality and local vendor services. *The Conversation*.
- Van Campenhout, B., & Miehe, C. (2021, February 4). Does bottom-up monitoring improve public services? What we found in Uganda. *The Conversation*.

Conferences & seminars

Great Lakes of Africa Centre (Institute of Development Policy) Seminar at University of Antwerp (2026, online) • Christmas Meeting of Belgian Economists (2025 in Brussels, Belgium) • EAAE Congress (2025 in Bonn, Germany) • Earth and Life Institute Seminar at UCLouvain (2025 in Louvain-la-Neuve, Belgium) • Development Economics Seminar at KU Leuven (2025 in Leuven, Belgium) • Lisbon Micro Group (2025 in Lisbon, Portugal) • Economics Seminar at Wageningen University (2025 in Wageningen, Netherlands) • Nova Economics Club (2024 in Lisbon, Portugal) • NOVAFRICA Conference (2024 in Lisbon, Portugal) • CSAE Conference (2023 in Oxford, UK) • NL-CGIAR Conference (2022, online) • ISSD Africa Synthesis Conference (2022 in Kigali, Rwanda) • AgEconMeeting (2022 in Göttingen, Germany) • Wageningen University EconMonday Seminar (2022 in Wageningen, Netherlands) • LICOS Seminar (2022 in Leuven, Belgium) • LICOS Ideas Exchange (2021 in Leuven, Belgium) • ASSA Annual Meeting (2021, online) • AAEA Annual Meeting (2020, online)

Projects & research grants

2025 – 2028	Fundação para a Ciência e a Tecnologia: “Urbanization meets the environment” with P. Vicente, S. Leeffer, & J. Macdonald	249,923 €
2025 – 2026	NL-CGIAR: “Optimizing performance of improved seed varieties for smallholder farmers in Uganda” with R. Sparrow	161,537 €
2024 – 2026	International Growth Centre: “Urbanization meets the environment” with P. Vicente, S. Leeffer, & J. Macdonald	87,878 £
2023 – 2025	International Growth Centre: “Urbanization meets the environment” with P. Vicente, S. Leeffer, & J. Macdonald	85,049 £
2019 – 2021	NL-CGIAR: “Policy and regulatory reform options for seed market development” with R. Sparrow, D. J. Spielman, B. Van Campenhout, & others	992,792 €

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Teaching experience	2025 – 2025	Development economics	Nova Univ. Lisbon, Portugal
	2021 – 2023	Introduction to the economics of development	KU Leuven, Belgium
	2021 – 2023	Development economics	KU Leuven, Belgium
	2020 – 2021	Lessons for the 21st century	KU Leuven, Belgium
	2015 – 2015	Introduction to controlling & cost accounting	Univ. of Potsdam, Germany
	2013 – 2014	Mathematics for economists I	Univ. of Potsdam, Germany
Memberships	Since 2024	Lisbon Micro Group (LMG)	
	Since 2023	American Economic Association (AEA)	
	Since 2023	European Economic Association (EEA)	
	Since 2022	European Association of Agricultural Economists (EAAE)	
	Since 2022	Agricultural Economics Society (AES)	
	Since 2020	Agricultural & Applied Economics Association (AAEA)	
Pre-analysis plans in AEA RCT Registry	2024	Urbanization meets the environment	
	2020	Demand and supply factors constraining the sustainability of an efficient seed system	
	2020	Community advocacy forums and public service delivery	
Field experience	Nov '25 Uganda	Focus group discussions to complement data from Demand and supply factors constraining the sustainability of an efficient seed system	
	Jul–Aug '24 Mozambique	Design and implementation of intervention for Urbanization meets the environment	
	Jan–Feb '22 Uganda	Midline data collection, intervention implementation for Demand and supply factors constraining the sustainability of an efficient seed system	
	Apr–Jun '21 Uganda	Baseline data collection, intervention implementation for Demand and supply factors constraining the sustainability of an efficient seed system	
	Aug '19 Uganda	Preparation of endline data collection for Community advocacy forums and public service delivery	
Peer reviews	NOVAFRICA Conference • American Journal of Agricultural Economics • Journal of the AAEA • XVIII Congress of the EAAE • PLOS ONE		
Languages	German (native) • English (fluent) • Dutch (fluent) • Spanish (basic)		
Software	R • LyX/LaTeX • GitHub • Microsoft Office		
References	Johan Swinnen • Ph.D. supervisor IFPRI, KU Leuven email	Bjorn Van Campenhout • mentor IFPRI, KU Leuven email	
	Pedro C. Vicente • supervisor Nova University Lisbon email	Robert Sparrow • former supervisor Wageningen University email	